Lab 20: Retry the timeout once, then answer from the real record

Topic 2: Tool Design & MCP Integration · Task 2.2: Implement structured error responses for MCP tools
Runs on Simulator 1: Customer Support Resolution Agent · Self-practice
Source: Built from exam guide task statement 2.2 (no practice question covers this angle)

Commit to an answer first

The order lookup for ORD-5504 times out on the first try. How should the tool report that, and what should the agent do next?

A. errorCategory plus isRetryable lets the agent decide.

B. A generic "lookup failed" with no hint about retrying.

Simulate the solution

```
# In the browser: open Simulator 1, then Lab 20
cd labs
uv run serve.py

# In Claude Code, from the labs folder
/lab 20

# In a terminal, from simulators/simulator-1-customer-support/
uv run support_agent.py --case CS-06
```

What you should see

ORD-5504 times out once, one retry follows, and the reply uses the real order record.

Open `simulators/simulator-1-customer-support/evidence/` and find it yourself.

The answer

A. errorCategory plus isRetryable lets the agent decide.

Now change one thing

Copy a file in cases/ to a new CS id, change the customer's message and expected disposition, rerun with --case, then score it with evaluate.py.